

A new legal battle over abortion pill access

Ruling that mifepristone can be picked up only in-person spurs lawsuits

BY PRAVEENA SOMASUNDARAM, RACHEL ROUBEIN AND JUSTIN JOUVENAL

Two drug manufacturers asked the Supreme Court on Saturday to temporarily allow patients to continue to access a commonly used abortion pill through the mail.

Danco Laboratories filed the first emergency appeal after the U.S. Court of Appeals for the 5th Circuit in New Orleans issued a ruling Friday making it harder for women to access the abortion pill, mifepristone. Later Saturday, GenBioPro, which manufacturers a generic version of the drug, also formally requested the justices weigh in.

The appellate court reinstated a requirement that mifepristone can only be picked up in person.

It's unclear when the Supreme Court might rule on the emergency applications.

The Friday ruling came in a Louisiana lawsuit against the Food and Drug Administration, which had previously allowed patients to access pills through telehealth and the mail. The rise of the use of such drugs has troubled antiabortion advocates.

"It bears emphasis how unprecedented the Fifth Circuit's order is," Danco wrote in its application to the Supreme Court. "Never before has a federal court purported to immediately enjoin a several years' old drug approval; restrict a distribution system for that drug that manufacturers, providers, patients, and pharmacies have all been using for years; or reinstate conditions that FDA determined do not meet the mandatory statutory criteria."

After the Supreme Court eliminated *Roe v. Wade* in 2022, legal experts and abortion advocates forged a new path to preserve access, even in states with severe restrictions.

In eight Democratic-led states where the procedure remained le-

SEE APPEAL ON A13



ANNIE FLANAGAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

He fought for Black voting, now fears a wipeout in South

Press Robinson had to show he could read, before he was allowed to become the first member of his family to vote in the 1950s. In the 1970s, he filed a trailblazing lawsuit that cleared the way for him to be the first Black person elected to the city's school board.

It was a trajectory the son of a poor sharecropper in the Jim Crow South never envisioned was possible.

His hard work and drive was not enough. Robinson also credited his progress and that of millions of other Black people to the Voting Rights Act. The law, signed in 1965, outlawed discriminatory practices in elections like the literacy test Robinson encountered and the gerrymanders that kept him off the school board.

Hundreds of minority officeholders may lose their seats after ruling on Voting Rights Act

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL IN BATON ROUGE

Having lived the rise in Black political power across the South enabled by the VRA, Robinson worries he is now a witness to its dramatic demise after the Supreme Court sharply limited the last vestige of the landmark law often called the crown jewel of the civil rights movement. The ruling could put hundreds

of minority officeholders at risk of losing their seats, and diminish opportunity for the next generation of leaders.

At 88, Robinson was on the losing side of the case, likely one of the final acts in a life of activism.

"That law passed in 1965 was the bedrock of improvement of life in America for people of color," Robinson said. "This is a Louisiana case, but the result is not going to be limited to Louisiana. It's going to set the stage for redistricting in the entire country."

The justices struck down a second Black-majority congressional district

SEE VOTING RIGHTS ON A6

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Press Robinson, at 88, was on the losing side of the case, likely one of the final acts in a life of activism.

Spirit Airlines shutters after bailout plan fails

Cost of jet fuel proved too much for long-struggling innovator of cheap flights

BY CHRISTOPHER ROWLAND AND AMY B WANG

Spirit Airlines met its demise Saturday after a pair of bankruptcies and even talk of a possible White House intervention failed to save it, spelling the end of a low-budget carrier known for taking "a la carte" flying — with fees for everything from checked bags to water — to an extreme.

Spirit grounded what remained of its bright-yellow fleet at 3 a.m. and closed its call centers, leaving travelers to search for flights on its competitors. It was a final disruption for fliers who, since the airline's founding in its current form in 1992, endured a sometimes rocky relationship with the company.

Spirit offered rock-bottom fares, but all you got was a seat. Even minimal creature comforts cost extra.

"That's the way the customer experience worked. It was somewhere between indifferent and antagonistic," said aviation analyst Robert Mann. "But that was enough to get people to fly. If the fare was low enough, you would suck it up, take a seat and press on."

After struggling financially for years and failing in its effort several years ago to merge with rival JetBlue, Spirit said the skyrocketing costs of jet fuel because of the war in Iran proved to be too much.

"Sustaining the business required hundreds of millions of additional dollars of liquidity that Spirit simply does not have and could not procure," CEO Dave Davis said in a one-page statement announcing the closure. "This is tremendously disappointing and not the outcome any of us wanted."

The airline said it would automatically process refunds for any flights booked directly with the company, while those who

SEE SPIRIT ON A9

Q&A: How to get a refund and other pointers for customers. **A9**

Two paths of trauma after Jewish Museum killings

A year later, she's sought to build bridges, while he's sharpened his political edges

BY MICHAEL LARIS



ALEX KENT/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

JoJo Drake Kalin and husband Yoni River Kalin both encountered the alleged gunman a year ago.

JoJo Drake Kalin was trying to keep from crying as she stood at a microphone in a tent beside her synagogue recounting the night a young couple was executed outside the Capital Jewish Museum in downtown Washington.

JoJo and her husband, Yoni River Kalin, had been at the museum that night almost a year ago for an event centered on humanitarian aid in Gaza when the alleged killer slipped back inside after the shooting and sat among the guests. JoJo noticed he looked distressed and went to get him a cup of ice water. She felt his sweat as their hands brushed. Yoni picked up the red-and-white kaffiyeh — a headscarf and symbol of Palestinian resistance — that the man dropped and tried to hand it back to him.

Moments later, they would watch authorities drag him away as he yelled, "Free, free Palestine."

Now, months later, JoJo stood in front of a crowd, delivering a speech she had been asked to prepare for the holiest day in the Jewish calendar, Yom Kippur. She talked about the couple who died

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POLITICS & THE NATION
Elon Musk's provocations and friction with the judge dominate trial. **A3**

ARTS & STYLE
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Cherie DeVaux becomes first female trainer to win the Kentucky Derby. **B1**

BUSINESS
Meet the man turning the Pentagon into a venture capital firm. **B7**



TRAVEL
How to save money and avoid large crowds on your summer vacation.

THE REGION
An island depends on him to run the ferry. Who will do it after Terry? **B13**

COMICS.....**INSERT**
OBITUARIES.....**B16**
OPINION PAGES.....**A17**
WORLD NEWS.....**A14**

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The Washington Post / Year 149, No. 54570

